Nikolai KHRUSTALEV

Technical Consultant | AI & Data Solutions | PoC/MVP Delivery

linkedin.com/in/khrustalev github.com/vbalashi
+31 634 56 96 56 vbalashi@gmail.com
Rotterdam, the Netherlands

Summary

I build AI and data solutions from scattered components to working demos. 20 years across telecom, data analytics, and AI — always at the intersection of technology and customer outcomes. My strength: seeing the whole system when everyone else sees their own part — and making it run.

Professional Experience

Present – May 2024 — **Lead Technical Consultant at OpenText, The Netherlands,**

- Deployed 5 AI-powered document intelligence PoCs within 2–3 months each — from bare VM/K8s to working solution
- Built NiFi pipelines extracting metadata from unstructured documents (IDs, entities, dates) across text, images, PDFs, video, audio
- Trained customer teams on NiFi flow creation, component selection, and scripting (Python, Lua)
- Consulted enterprise customers on deployment architecture, use cases, and data processing strategies
- Delivered solutions for automotive and energy sectors — document classification, PII detection, data redaction, file migration

Apache NiFi | Python | Kubernetes | Docker | IDOL/Knowledge Discovery | OCR | NLP | LLMs | Entity Extraction | Solution Architecture

Apr 2024 – Apr 2021 — **Data Practice Consultant → Manager at EPAM Systems, The Netherlands,**

Embedded at Liberty Global and Zalando as technical consultant on data analytics and migration projects.

- Built analytical dashboards from Wi-Fi telemetry data for Liberty Global — explored datasets, joined sources, visualized network performance in Looker/BigQuery
- Advised Zalando migration team (10 people) during transition from legacy distributed DB to Amazon Redshift
- Led technology assessment for Liberty Global regional subsidiary — interviewed engineering teams, mapped architecture, presented transition recommendations to CTO
- Grew from Consultant to Manager grade during tenure (promoted 2024)

Python | SQL | BigQuery | Looker | Amazon Redshift | Apache Spark | GCP | Pandas | Jupyter Notebooks | Stakeholder Management

Feb 2022 – Mar 2021 — **Technical Consultant (Contract) at AB Handshake Corporation, Remote, USA**

- Led technical onboarding of telecom operators onto anti-fraud platform — managed integration planning, architecture diagrams, customer coordination
- Proposed strategic product pivot: recommended leading with proven fraud analytics product — reduced time-to-value for customer onboarding
- Introduced ticketing system for onboarding tracking as customer pipeline grew

Technical Consulting | Integration Architecture | Telecommunications | Project Management

Mar 2021 – Jan 2018 — **Solutions Consultant at Nokia, Russia,**

- Coordinated €45M IoT infrastructure migration project (CDMA→5G) across ~20 people — owned OSS workstream, presented to customer in Cologne
- Deployed and presented Nokia Video Analytics (Bell Labs edge ML) at industry conference (~200 attendees) — set up demo server personally
- Supported 4-year SON (Self-Organizing Network) sale to MTS Russia — presented capabilities, bridged customer and product line
- Covered CIS/EMEA region: customer presentations, solution sizing, technical consulting for telecom operators

Solution Architecture | Pre-Sales Engineering | IoT | 5G | Telecommunications | Stakeholder Management | Customer-Facing Presentations

Dec 2017
Nov 2012

Pre-Sales Engineer at Nokia / Nokia Siemens Networks, Russia,

- Pre-sales of OSS/NetAct and analytics solutions across CIS/EMEA operators — customer presentations, equipment sizing, technical proposals
- Trained account and presales teams on new Nokia products and technologies
- Traveled to 10+ countries for customer events and technical workshops

Pre-Sales Engineering | OSS/BSS | Telecommunications | Technical Documentation | Customer-Facing Presentations

Oct 2012
Oct 2005

System Engineer at Siemens / Nokia Siemens Networks, Russia, France, UAE, Czech Republic,

- Deployed first 3G video calling solution for MTS Moscow — self-trained in UK, mounted and configured equipment solo
- Commissioned fully virtualized VAS platform (SMS, MMS, WAP) for Bouygues Telecom in Paris on VMware
- Maintained VAS platforms for operator DU in Dubai (~9 months) — offered permanent relocation twice due to strong customer relationship
- Deployed telecom VAS and VoIP platforms across CIS, EMEA — hands-on commissioning engineer

Telecommunications | VMware | Linux | VoIP | System Engineering | Technical Documentation

Skills

AI & Data	Apache NiFi, Python, SQL, LLMs, Vector Search, NLP, OCR, Document Processing, Enterprise Search
Cloud & Infra	Kubernetes, Docker, GCP, BigQuery, Looker, Amazon Redshift, AWS, Linux
Architecture	Solution Architecture, Integration Architecture, PoC/MVP Delivery, Technical Architecture
Analytics	Pandas, Apache Spark, Jupyter Notebooks, Data Visualization, ETL, Data Analytics
Telecom	OSS/BSS, 5G, IoT, Telecommunications
Soft Skills	Stakeholder Management, Customer-Facing Presentations, Technical Documentation, Cross-Functional Team Leadership

Languages

Russian	●●●●●
English	●●●●●
Dutch	●●○○○
German	●○○○○

Education

2005 Moscow State University of Forestry Engineering
Master's in Applied Mathematics & Computer Science